Coptic Memorisation Game

A vocabulary-building matching game — Ages 6+ — 2-6 Players — 20-30 Minutes

Age Range	Players	Play Time	Difficulty
6+	**2-6**	**20-30 minutes**	**Easy-Medium**

About This Game

The Coptic Memorisation Game helps children and families learn Coptic vocabulary through a hands-on matching mechanic. By matching Coptic words with their English pictures, players build familiarity with the sacred language of the Coptic Church.

> **Formation Goal:** Learning the sacred language of the Coptic Church through playful repetition and visual association.

Components

The game uses three decks of cards:

- **Word Deck (15 cards)** — Each card has a Coptic word on one side and is blank on the other.
- **Picture Deck (15 cards)** — Each card has a picture and English text on one side and is blank on the other.
- **Double Deck (15 cards)** — Each card has a Coptic word on one side and the corresponding picture (with English text) on the other.

Setup (Standard Match)

1. Print the card sheets on cardstock (110 lb recommended). Cut along the card borders.
2. Place the **Word Deck** face-down (blank side up) in a grid pattern.
3. Place the **Double Deck** with the Coptic words facing down (pictures face up) in a corresponding grid pattern.
4. Note: the grids should be the same size, but the cards should be in random positions within each grid.

How to Play (Standard Match)

1. The youngest player goes first.
2. On your turn, turn over one card from the **Word Deck**, revealing a Coptic word.
3. Now turn over one card from the **Double Deck** (flipping it from the picture side to the Coptic side).
4. **If the Coptic words match:** You found a pair! Keep both cards and place them in front of you.
5. **If the words do not match:** Return both cards to their original positions (face-down for the Word card, picture-up for the Double card).
6. Play always passes to the next player — a successful match does *not* grant another turn.
7. When all cards are matched, the player with the most pairs wins!

Strategy Tip

If you recognise the Coptic word when you flip it, you can easily find the matching picture in the Double Deck. If you don't recognise it, guess! When you flip the Double card, you'll see whether the Coptic side matches — and either way, you'll learn the word for next time.

Game Variants

Variant 1: Picture Match

This variant uses the **Picture Deck** instead of the Word Deck.

1. Place the **Picture Deck** face-down (blank side up) in a grid.
2. Place the **Double Deck** with the picture side down (Coptic words face up).
3. On your turn, flip a Picture card to reveal an English word and picture. Then flip a Double card to see if the picture matches.
4. All other rules remain the same.

Variant 2: Pronunciation

1. Place all the **Word Deck** cards in a bag or face-down pile.

2. Players take turns drawing a card.
3. If you can pronounce the Coptic word correctly, keep the card.
4. If not, return the card to the bag.
5. When all cards are collected, the player with the most cards wins.

Tip: An adult or older student who knows some Coptic should be the judge for pronunciation.

Variant 3: Vocabulary

1. Place all the **Picture Deck** cards in a bag or face-down pile.
2. Players take turns drawing a card.
3. If you can say the matching Coptic word, keep the card.
4. If not, return the card to the bag.
5. When all cards are collected, the player with the most cards wins.

Tips for Parents and Teachers

- For younger children or beginners, start with only 8-10 word pairs to keep the game shorter.
- Practise saying each Coptic word together when a match is made.
- Point out Coptic words children have learned when you hear them in the liturgy or hymns.
- Use the Pronunciation and Vocabulary variants as warm-up activities for Coptic language classes.
- The Double Deck can also be used as flash cards for individual study.

> *"Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly in all wisdom, teaching and admonishing one another in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs."* — Colossians 3:16